

you need to print large volumes and/or are sharing the printer over a network. If the printer is not fast, you'd end up wasting a lot of time just waiting for your documents to print and probably hold up the prints fired by other users on the network.

The fastest printer that we received was the **Lexmark Optra M412**, which was able to print text at a splendid rate of 16.61 prints per minute (ppm). This printer had the most robust build compared to the others in the comparison test, that would give the printer a sturdy paper path.

The first runner-up was Hewlett-Packard's LaserJet 1220Se. This one was able to print the text document at the rate of 14.1 ppm. The next printer that came close was Hewlett-Packard's LaserJet 1200, with a speed of 13.5 ppm.

This was surprising as we were expecting both the Hewlett-Packard models to achieve almost the same score as they belong to the same 1200 series of printers and use the same print engine. The only difference between these printers is that the LaserJet 1220Se comes with the scanning assembly as a standard part and the LaserJet 1200 doesn't. Other printers that were able to come close to these scores were the Samsung ML 6060N and the Wipro Laser 1500 that scored a speed of 11.89 ppm and 11.96 ppm, respectively.

In printing the vector images, the **Lexmark Optra M412** again took the overall position by printing 13.44 copies of prints in a minute. This was a very crucial test, and most of the printers were either unable to print this document or started to spool the print for more than 1 hour. This could be because the printers were not PostScript enabled or the drivers supplied with these printers did not contain support for PostScript printing.

The printers that were able to print these documents were the Lexmark M412 that was able to print the document the fastest, the Hewlett-Packard LaserJet 1200, the Hewlett-Packard LaserJet 1220Se.

The Epson EPL 5800 and the Epson EPL 5700L weren't able to print the exact image. That

HP Laserjet 1200: Gives good speeds



TEST PROCESS

We evaluated each printer's performance on two basic criteria: print speed and image quality. To ascertain the print speed we logged the time taken to print

1. A sample document file consisting of five sample letters, each containing text and a graphical logo, printed in black and white and greyscale mode.
2. A text document prepared in Microsoft Word. A 100 copies of this page were fired.
3. A page containing vector images (100 copies printed). The file had a full bleed size and a thumbnail-sized vector image.
4. A document containing an image, which was printed in normal mode (see image by the side).

Similar documents were used to ascertain the image quality both in terms of text reproduction as well as replication of image and printing in variable shades of grey. We also



checked for quality in the vector image.

Points were also awarded for other characteristics such as sturdy build quality, thorough documentation, bundled software, number of paper trays, transparency printing, dual-sided printing, economy mode support, post-script printing, etc.

means the printer first spooled the entire document before printing the vector image. But unlike the other printers, the EPL 5700L printer was not able to continue with printing. After printing the first page, it again started the entire spooling process for the second page.

This definitely was not practical, as this would take a long time to print a desired number of pages. The Epson EPL 5800 was able to take 6.90 prints in a minute, but was not able to print the exact image that was submitted for printing. Both the Hewlett-Packard printers did well and were able to print the vector images with ease but not as fast as the Lexmark Optra M412.

The Hewlett-Packard LaserJet 1220Se was able to print 7.40 prints of the vector printout in a minute, in contrast to the Hewlett-Packard LaserJet 1200 that was able to take 6.84 prints in the same amount of time.

Next, we logged the time taken to print images. There wasn't much difference with regard to the text print timings. The only difference noticed was the printer's spooling time that was more for image prints, since the file size of images is greater than text files.

Here too the fastest was the **Lexmark Optra M412**, which took 15.82 prints in a minute. The printer that came second was the Hewlett-Packard LaserJet 1220Se, with 13.39 copies of the image in a minute; and the Hewlett-Packard LaserJet 1200 that was able to print 12.05 copies in a minute. These



More Info on
the test process and the
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Mindware

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